

5-2 Final Project Part II Milestone Two: Organizational Vision and Culture

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Abstract

The milestone reflects on organizational scenarios to demonstrate understanding of leadership in organizational behavior. This analysis focuses on various organizational leadership situations dealing with skills assessment, team-building, vision and culture, problem-solving, and conflict management

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Our textbook mentions that having a vision is an integral part of strategic leadership (DuBrin, 2015). Mark Zuckerberg, the world's youngest billionaire, founded Facebook with his college roommates based on his visionary idea that exploited people's desire for social hierarchies and elitism (Mezrich, 2009). In the early days of Facebook, Zuckerberg used unorthodox methods to get the results he wanted and that is still how he runs his empire.

In order for a leader to make effective use of organizational politics, they must be aware of specific tactics and strategies (DuBrin, 2015). The Facebook process of getting talent from all parts of the company to get together regularly, leverage their infrastructure and actually implement their ideas is a competitive advantage (Hanif, 2016). So by recruiting the best talent and empowering them by allowing for them to be creative, Zuckerberg is able to positively shape the culture at Facebook.

Leadership Analysis

In his 2012 article for Business Insider, Nicholas Carlson used firsthand accounts and publically released correspondence to try and understand what it was like to work for Zuckerberg in the early years of Facebook. Zuckerberg was known for being a cut-throat leader that was comfortable in his position and had no problems leading others (Carlson, 2012). Over the years, insiders at Facebook have consistently explained Zuckerberg's style as follows:

- Zuck expects debate.
- Zuck isn't sentimental.
- Zuck experiences things contextually.
- Zuck pushes people.

Facebook employees insist that Zuckerberg is not mean or autocratic, but also does not provide emotional coddling because he expects people to be confident in what they are doing.

Carlson referred to Yishan Wong's comments regarding whether or not it is difficult to work for Mark Zuckerberg. She explains that "Zuck" is not an overly charismatic personality who is easy to get along with. Instead, he is demanding and lives to ensure that Facebook succeeds in its mission (Carlson, 2012). She confirms what many others have asserted: Zuckerberg is difficult to read and sometimes listens to what you are saying without acknowledging your comments. Wong goes on to say:

"I would characterize him as "tough but fair." He's not a pain in the ass to work with if you're the type of person who is looking to achieve greater and greater things"

Analysis of Best Practices

Ben Mezrich details how Zuckerberg made decisions early in the history of Facebook that shaped the way the company was organized and would eventually get him sued for hundreds of millions of dollars. Zuckerberg founded the company with his college dorm mates including his best friend at the time, Eduardo Saverin (Mezrich, 2009). The initial startup capital injection in fact came from Saverin and he was Facebook's first CFO. It was not long before Saverin saw the potential for monetization of the highly popular social networking website which at this early point was only available at a few select private universities. This is where Zuckerberg began to push back.

It is now funny to think of Facebook without advertisements, but early on Zuckerberg was vehemently opposed to the idea (Mezrich, 2009). While his CFO was in New York City trying to sell ad space to executives on Madison Avenue, Mark was nurturing a relationship with Sean Parker that would eventually turn Facebook into a multibillion dollar enterprise. What

Parker offered – what made him more appealing than Saverin – was his access to venture capitalists like Peter Thiel.

After Parker convinced Zuckerberg to pitch Facebook to Thiel, things moved very quickly. Thiel's venture fund, Clarium Capital, was an early investor in Facebook and the sizeable injection of capital made it so Zuckerberg didn't have to rely on selling ads on his social network for them to expand operations. Based on that fact, Zuckerberg allowed Thiel and his lawyers to push Saverin out of the company. Lawyers from Clarium Capital reincorporated Facebook and divvied up ownership in a way that diluted Saverin's share to less than half of one percent. Facebook continued with Zuckerberg as CEO and Sean Parker as the first president of the company.

Application of Examples

Zuckerberg's key strategic business strategies are a preference for moving at high speeds, and gaining a competitive advantage through hiring talented people. In his 2016 article for The Huffington Post, Ali Hanif breaks down how Zuckerberg still uses one of his favorite methods to spur innovation and empower his employees – the Hackathon. Employees from all across the organization from different teams and locations come together to brainstorm and actually build some of the things they truly want and believe will make the experience for Facebook users better (Hanif, 2016).

Zuckerberg uses these events, which happen every couple of months and last for a few days, to unleash the creativity of his organization. He truly believes that by empowering members from all ranks and allowing their products to speak for themselves he is utilizing the most valuable asset any organization has – human capital. The key element of how Facebook stays competitive in the constantly evolving world of social media can be summed up by one

core belief that dominates Hackathons: prototypes don't need to be polished, they just need to work in the beginning (Hanif, 2016).

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